SIXT / GROWTH & CRM / CASE STUDY WALKTHROUGH

# Converting the 70%

Three CRM initiatives to move Sixt US leisure customers from one-time to repeat — each anchored to a signal on the conversion dashboard, each with a measurement plan.

North-star **Core Repeat Conversion Rate**

Source **Sixt CRM Dashboard** (generated mock data)

Format **Dashboard tour + 3 experiments**

# 70% of US leisure customers rent once and never return — 2,800 of the 4,000, split 50/50 across the two channels.


Headline KPIs — All Rentals, 2026

## THE ONE NUMBER THIS IS ABOUT

The **Core Repeat Conversion Rate** (orange) = unique customers in the period who are lifetime repeaters ÷ all unique customers in the period. It sits just above its 30% lifetime baseline and moves year to year: **34.5%** in 2024, **36.6%** in 2025, **32.7%** 2026 year-to-date.

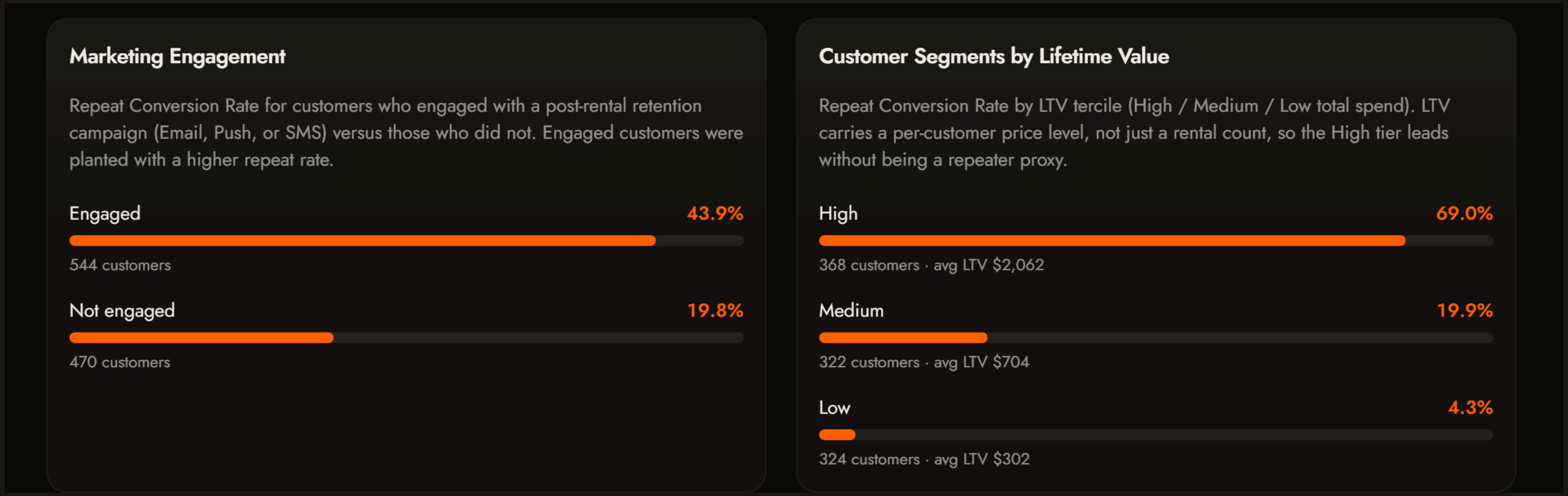
## READING THE DASHBOARD

One segment toggle (All / B2C / B2P) and one year selector recompute every view in the browser. Six views feed the story: headline, channel, engagement, LTV, cohort & frequency, assumptions. Each initiative that follows is tied to one of them.

# Reached customers repeat at twice the rate

Customers who engaged with a retention campaign repeat at **43.9%** versus **19.8%** for those who did not (2026 population). The relationship is planted in the mock data and correlational by construction — but the **reach gap** is the real leverage: about **64%** of B2C customers are touched by a campaign, against only **39%** of B2P.

The programme is not yet run against the customers most likely to churn. (The High-LTV tier repeats at **~69%**, but LTV is a price-level proxy, not a lever — it says where value sits, not what to send.)




Marketing Engagement & LTV segments — All Rentals, 2026

# Put every one-time renter into a post-rental retention flow

The bet: a light, well-timed sequence after the trip keeps Sixt in the consideration set for the next one. The barrier for most one-timers is recall at the moment of the next trip, not intent.

## HYPOTHESIS

> **IF** a completed one-time rental is enrolled within 7 days into a four-touch flow (thank-you → destination tips → day-75 “ready for your next trip” → win-back at day 200), **THEN** its probability of a second rental within 365 days rises by **≥ 3 pp**, **BECAUSE** the block is memory at the decision moment, not desire.

## A/B TEST

| | |
|---|---|
| UNIT | Individual customer, at rental completion. |
| SPLIT | 50 / 50 at return, continuous enrolment. |
| TREATMENT | Enrolled in the retention flow. |
| CONTROL | Transactional messages only (receipt, damage, survey). |
| CHANNELS | Email (primary) · Push (if app) · SMS (day-75 only). |
| READOUT | Cohorts at 90 / 180 / 365 days. |

## SUCCESS METRIC

PRIMARY Repeat conversion rate at 365 days, treatment vs control. Ship on ≥ 2 pp absolute lift at 95% confidence.

SECONDARY Time-to-second-rental; rentals per customer at 365 days.

GUARDRAIL Unsubscribe < 0.5% per send; contribution margin per rental flat or up.

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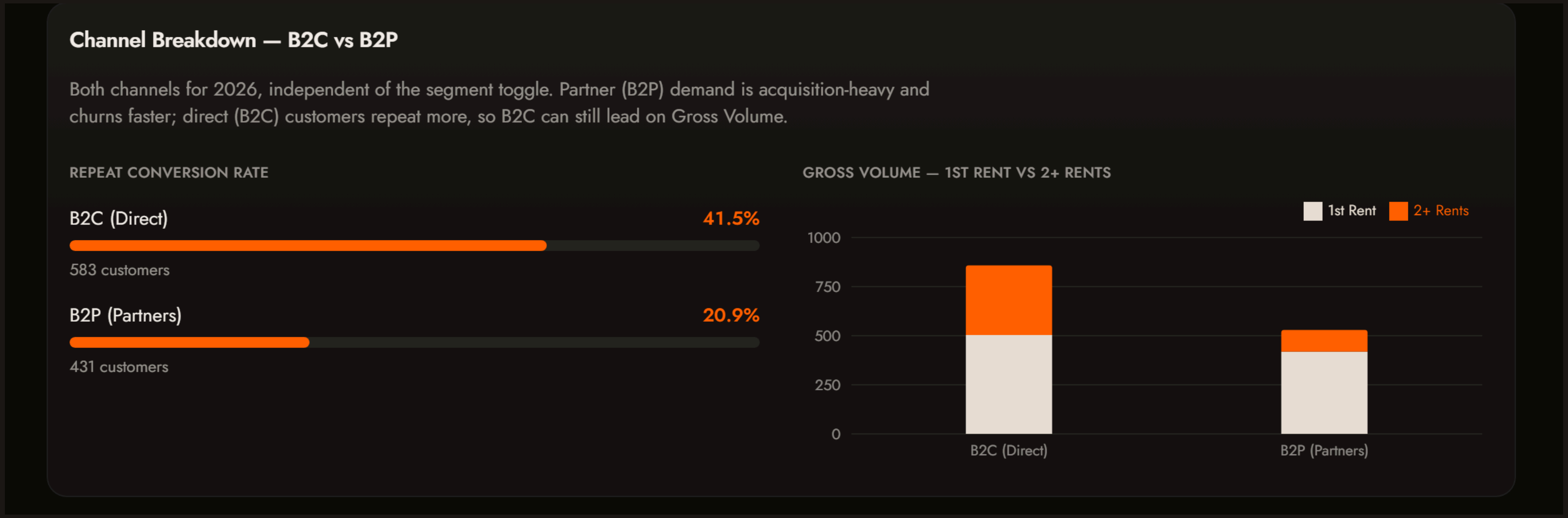
HIGH – DIRECT The primary metric *is* the north-star. A 3 pp lift across the enrolled base moves the blended rate by roughly **2 pp**.

# Same intake, half the retention

B2P (Partners) repeats at **20.9%** against B2C's **41.5%**. The book acquires the same number of one-time customers through each channel (**~1,400**), but B2P is **80% one-time** to B2C's 62% — the single largest drag on the blended rate.

B2C can still show higher Gross Volume because its repeaters add extra contracts. The gap is not a volume problem — it is a **relationship** problem: a broker booking never creates the account, the saved payment method or the marketing consent that a direct booking does.




Channel Breakdown — both channels, 2026

# Move B2P (broker) customers onto a direct relationship

The bet: B2P customers don't come back because their next booking sits with the broker, not Sixt. Give them a reason to book direct once, and the relationship — and the consent — follows.

## HYPOTHESIS

> **IF** a B2P customer is prompted at pickup or return to create a direct Sixt account, with a bounded incentive on their next booking on sixt.com (€25 off, expires in 6 months), **THEN** their 365-day repeat rate moves a third of the way toward B2C (**~20% → ~26%**), **BECAUSE** the first direct booking establishes the account, payment method and consent a broker booking never creates.

## A/B TEST

| | |
|---|---|
| UNIT | B2P rental, randomised at pickup. |
| SPLIT | 50 / 50, stratified by broker partner. |
| TREATMENT | Account-creation prompt + next-direct-booking incentive. |
| CONTROL | Standard B2P experience, no prompt. |
| CHANNELS | Email + SMS · QR prompt on the rental agreement. |
| READOUT | 180 and 365 days; funnel checked weekly. |

## SUCCESS METRIC

PRIMARY 365-day repeat conversion rate, treated B2P vs control.

FUNNEL Direct-account creation → next rental books direct → incentive redemption.

GUARDRAIL Incremental margin per converted customer positive after incentive cost; control isolates customers who would have rebooked anyway.

**HIGH** Closing a third of the B2C–B2P gap across the ~1,750 B2P customers lifts the blended Core Repeat Conversion Rate by **~2–3 pp**.

# Rebooking happens in two windows — Q4 acquisitions miss both

> Time-to-next-rental has two clean clusters: **60–90 days** (frequent renters, ~1,090 customers) and **~330–365 days** (annual-trip renters, ~110 customers).

The cohort matrix adds the timing problem: Jan–Sep acquisitions rebook at **~38%** ever, but **Oct–Dec acquisitions rebook at 2–6%**. They are acquired off-peak, and a generic monthly newsletter never lands inside a planning window.

**Cohort & Frequency**

Rows are the month of a customer's first-ever rental in 2026. A cell is the share of that cohort with a repeat rental in that elapsed-time window; "Rebooked" is the share that returned at all. Read the early-month rows for the conversion signal: October-onward cohorts (dimmed) are acquired off-peak and rebook little, and the most recent cohorts have not had time to return.

| FIRST RENTAL | COHORT | 0-3 MO | 3-6 MO | 6-12 MO | 12 MO+ | REBOOKED |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Jan 2026 | 74 | 64% | 27% | 3% | 0% | 64% |
| Feb 2026 | 70 | 57% | 34% | 0% | 0% | 57% |
| Mar 2026 | 98 | 44% | 20% | 0% | 0% | 44% |
| Apr 2026 | 125 | 37% | 2% | 0% | 0% | 37% |
| May 2026 | 156 | 41% | 0% | 0% | 0% | 41% |
| Jun 2026 too recent | 132 | 0% | 0% | 0% | 0% | 0% |
| Jul 2026 too recent | 136 | 0% | 0% | 0% | 0% | 0% |
| Aug 2026 too recent | 131 | 0% | 0% | 0% | 0% | 0% |

Time between one rental and the customer's next one. Two clusters: frequent repeaters at 60-90 days, seasonal (annual-trip) repeaters at 330-365 days.



Cohort & Frequency — All Rentals, 2026

# Time re-engagement to the two natural rebooking windows

The bet: a message inside a trip-planning window converts far better than a fixed monthly newsletter. This initiative rides on Initiative 1's population — it is a timing change, not a new audience.

## HYPOTHESIS

**IF** the generic monthly newsletter is replaced by two behaviour-timed triggers — a “next trip?” nudge at day 75 and a “book your summer trip again” reminder at month 11 for summer renters — **THEN** second-rental rate rises, most for the Q4-acquired cohort, **BECAUSE** the send now coincides with when the customer is choosing their next rental.

## A/B TEST

| | |
|---|---|
| POPULATION | Within Initiative 1's enrolled group. |
| SPLIT | 50 / 50, stratified by acquisition month (Jun–Aug vs Oct–Dec). |
| TREATMENT | Cadence-timed triggers, replacing the newsletter. |
| CONTROL | Generic monthly newsletter. |
| CHANNELS | Day-75: Email + SMS + Push · Month-11: Email + Push. |
| READOUT | 120 days (frequent arm), 400 days (seasonal arm). |

## SUCCESS METRIC

| | |
|---|---|
| PRIMARY | Second-rental rate at 120 days (frequent) and 400 days (seasonal) vs control. |
| EFFICIENCY | Incremental repeat conversions per 1,000 sends; send volume neutral or lower. |
| SEGMENT | Repeat-rate lift for the Oct–Dec acquisition cohort specifically. |

**MEDIUM – COMPOUNDING** Smaller standalone effect — the seasonal arm is only ~110 customers today — but it multiplies Initiative 1 (same population, better timing) and rescues the near-zero Q4 cohort.

# One measurement spine under all three

| | |
|---|---|
| NORTH-STAR | Core Repeat Conversion Rate — unique customers in an acquisition cohort with a 2nd-plus lifetime rental ÷ cohort size — read at fixed horizons `90 / 180 / 365 / 400 days` because rebooking is bimodal. |
| DESIGN | Randomised holdout, never pre / post. Seasonality and the double-digit growth trend would otherwise contaminate the read. |
| INCREMENTALITY | A permanent `10%` global control, refreshed yearly, measures the whole programme against no CRM contact. |
| DECISION RULE | Ship when the 365-day repeat-rate lift is **at least +2 pp** absolute at 95% confidence *and* contribution margin per customer is not down. |
| GUARDRAILS | Opt-out rate, spam-complaint rate, margin per rental, and send fatigue (open / click trend) tracked on every arm. |
| POWER | Detecting a **+2 pp** lift on a ~20% base needs ~6,500 customers per arm. Initiatives 1 & 3 reach that in ~1 quarter at production volume; Initiative 2 (B2P only) in ~4–5 months. |

# What I’d run, and in what order

PARALLEL

Run Initiatives 1 and 2 at the same time — different populations, no interference.

THEN

Start Initiative 3 once Initiative 1 has a stable enrolled base (~1 month in).

IF ONLY ONE

Initiative 1 — widest population, fastest read, and its primary metric is the goal itself.

HONEST CAVEATS

Figures are from generated mock CRM data, not real Sixt results. The engagement-to-repeat and LTV-to-repeat relationships are correlational by construction; the effect sizes above are **targets the tests would establish**, not assumptions. The Q4 rebooking cliff is partly a property of the data model — but off-peak leisure renters being less repeat-prone is a plausible real effect worth testing.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Every initiative targets a mechanism Sixt can actually pull — a message, a prompt, a cadence — and every one reads out on the same orange number.